



Hole in the ozone

As it turns out the hole in the ozone has shown signs of repairing itself

Countdown to 2041

As of 22 Aug, exactly 11,089 days left to the re-negotiation of moratorium on mining in Antarctica. Head over to www.2041.com to find out more

Siddharth Parwatay

siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

Who is Sir Robert Swan? Some of you might have heard about the legend of the only man ever to have walked to both the North and the South Pole. Sir Robert Swan is the same living legend. And yet he is much more than just that. He is someone who has dedicated his entire life working towards the preservation of Antarctica as the last great wilderness left on earth. Through his expeditions, he witnessed firsthand the effects of global warming at both Poles. In Antarctica, his eyes forever changed colour after prolonged exposure under the hole in the ozone layer. In the Arctic, his team survived near-death encounters in a melting ocean, prematurely caused by global warming.

All of these experiences, and the fact

extreme hardships to not only motivate those around him into action, but also to spread the much needed awareness about the plight of Antarctica and the melting of the ice cover there.

It's a very peculiar human condition we're afflicted with – if someone were to come to us and talk about environmental issues; we won't not give it too much importance or a patient listen. But if someone comes along and says "hey you know what, listen to what I have to say because it'll make you a better person and help you in your business", we're all ears! Sir Robert does precisely that while at the same time getting across his environmental message.

Team Digit was privileged enough to be a part of one

dreamt that he wants to be the first person in the world to walk to both poles. To achieve his goal Sir Robert single headedly raised his money, which in itself is an inspiring story. "Raising 5 million US dollars at the age of 24 was probably more difficult than my journey itself" he jokes. His 900 mile journey to the South Pole stands as the longest unassisted walk ever made on earth. The journey inspired him to do something about environmental issues which he witnessed. Three years after reaching the



THE PATH LESS TRAVELLED

An extraordinary and inspiring story of Robert Swan OBE, a Polar explorer, environment leader and the first person ever to have walked to the North and South poles

that Sir Robert is an exceptionally gifted communicator led him to come up with his own brand of motivational coaching which he delivers all around the world. He uses his anecdotal experiences of

of his talks on his recent visit to India. His passion for the subject of Antarctic preservation struck a chord with us and hence we have this article in support of this most noble green initiative.

How did it all begin?

It all began as Sir Robert says in numerous interviews, when he was eleven. Surprised? Yes at the young age of eleven Sir Robert decided or rather

South Pole, Sir Robert Swan wanted to do something to further his cause. He assembled a global expeditionary team of eight people from seven nations and decided to walk to the North Pole. "If the 'Icewalk' mission were to be successful, I would become the first person stupid enough to do it" he said to us jokingly. And as history would have it, he set off and walked 1400 kilometres – every step away from land into the middle of the frozen sea. The journey wasn't easy. "On day two, we did just 2 kilometres. If you fall down any ice hole, it's straight into the icy blue sea. And yes you can be eaten by the mighty polar bear" said Sir Robert, "but we did it" he adds triumphantly.